Teacher and cover plan — Framing a site-specific visual brief

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 1 Part 2 · Big question: How do architects and public artists analyse spatial context, sightlines, and structural form to write a rigorous studio brief?

Learning goals and studio kit

• Analyse a site reference pack for architectural geometry, material texture, and audience viewpoint.

• Produce observational structural studies isolating primary load-bearing spans and negative-space voids.

• Draft a formal site-specific studio brief defining intent, material constraints, scale, and visual impact.

Studio kit: Site architecture reference packs, A3 studio brief sheets, 2B/4B graphite, fineliners, toned paper strips, acetate grids, scale rulers

Arrival and starter

Arrival: Why does a site-specific artwork look powerful in the exact square or building it was designed for, yet might look out of place anywhere else?

Starter question: Why is it essential to consider both the 3-metre view and the 30-centimetre view when framing a structural relief brief?

Teacher model (I do)

Step 1: Extract structural vectors and voids: I lay an acetate grid over the site card and sketch the primary cantilever span and triangular negative-space voids.

Step 2: Define macro silhouette and micro patina: I specify a three-level greyboard/foil relief profile with high-contrast slate and oxide patina.

Step 3: Write and annotate the formal Studio brief: I complete the four-part Studio brief sections (Intent, Geometry, Material spec, and Sightline check) around my elevation drawing.

Practice routes (Supported / Independent / Aspire)

Supported: Proportional elevation drawn with two texture swatches and four brief sections completed.

Independent: Two analytical site sketches, annotated 3-level elevation, and formal four-part studio brief.

Aspire: Orthographic elevation and side section profile with material key and design rationale.

TA and cover notes

TA focus: Provide clear acetate grids and architectural reference cards showing strong truss, arch, and cantilever forms.

Staff prep: Staff preparation only: review how to guide pupils from architectural photo analysis to an annotated elevation

and studio brief.